Xin He

RM 609, BLD 1, IIF USTC, Hefei, China
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MLFINA
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Employment

2024.08 - **University of Science and Technology of China**
Tenure-Track Associate Professor of Finance, Faculty of Business for Science and Technology

Faculty Affiliate, School of Management

2022.09 - 2024.07 **Hunan University**
Assistant Professor, College of Finance and Statistics

Education

2018 - 2022 **City University of Hong Kong**
Ph.D. in Management Sciences
Advisor: Prof. Guanhao Feng, Prof. Junbo Wang

2014 - 2018 **Shanghai Jiao Tong University**
B.S. in Industrial Engineering

Research Interest

Asset Pricing, Financial Econometrics, Financial LLM, Financial Machine Learning, Quantitative Investment

Publication

1. "Growing the Efficient Frontier on Panel Trees" with Lin William Cong, Guanhao Feng, and Jingyu He.
   Journal of Financial Economics, 2025, 167, 104024.
   Award: 2022 INQUIRE Europe Research Grant Award, 2024 IQAM Research Prize
   Media Coverage: FBS, IIF, IIF WeChat, XueShuo, Tsinghua Financial Review,

2. "Predicting Individual Corporate Bond Returns" with with Guanhao Feng, Yanchu Wang, and Chunchi Wu.
   Journal of Banking & Finance, 2025, 171, 107372.
   Media Coverage: XueShuo

3. "The Bright Side of Cross Ownership: Evidence From the Corporate Resilience to COVID-19 Crisis in China" with Yihui Chen and Haoyuan Wei.
   International Review of Finance, 2025, 25(1), e12468.

Working Paper

Apr. 2026 **Factor Investing and the Integration of Equity and Corporate Bond Markets**
- with Xinlei Hao, Junbo Wang, and Yuanzhi Wang.

Feb. 2026 **Stochastic Discount Factors with Cross-Asset Spillovers**
- with Doron Avramov.
- Award: 2025 INQUIRE Europe Research Grant Award, 2025 Best Paper Award at SYSU Conference on Big Data, AI, and FinTech.

Jan. 2026 **Optimal Portfolios with Trading Costs: The Case of Asset Spillovers**

Apr. 2026 **Generative Portfolio Selection, Transaction Cost, and Panel Tree**

Apr. 2026 **Characteristic-Based Benchmarks Revisited: Panel Tree Benchmarks for Corporate Bond Returns and Mutual Fund Evaluation**

Jan. 2026 **Corporate Bond Pricing via Panel Trees**

July. 2025 **AI Applications and the Opportunistic Insider Trading of Executives: Evidence from China**
- with Shuqi Zhang, Along Liu, Jibao Gu.
- Revise & Resubmit.

Nov. 2025 **When Competitors Go Public: Innovation Spillovers through Competitive Pressure and Learning Channels**
- with Yihui Chen, Zeyi Wu, Zhilin Wu.
- Revise & Resubmit.

Oct. 2024 **The Risk of Finance Words**
- with Xinbo Chen, and Bowen Du.
- Revise & Resubmit.

Oct. 2024 **Firm Engagement in Belt and Road Initiative and the Cross-Section of Stock Returns: Evidence from China**
- with Yihui Chen, Jinsheng Liao, and Xiaojuan Wang.

Reference

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Grant

2026 - 2026 | **PI**, University of Science and Technology of China Youth Innovation Fund
- Cross-Predictability in Empirical Asset Pricing: Theory and Evidence.

2026 - 2026 | **PI**, University of Science and Technology of China Global Initiative Fund
- Pricing Corporate Bond Returns with Panel Tree.

2023 - 2025 | Co-Investigator, General Research Fund at Hong Kong Research Grants Council
- with Jingyu He (PI) and Guanhao Feng (Co-I).
- Regression Tree for Portfolio Optimization and Imbalanced Data.

2022 - 2024 | Co-Investigator, General Research Fund at Hong Kong Research Grants Council
- with Guanhao Feng (PI), and Junbo Wang (Co-I).
- Textual Analysis of Corporate Bond Market.

Award

2025 | Best Paper Award, Conference on Big Data, AI, and FinTech, Sun Yat-sen University

2025 | INQUIRE Europe Research Grant Award

2024 | IQAM Research Award

2024 | Best Paper Award, Session for Corporate Finance and Accounting, 10th Jingshi Scholar Forum, Tsinghua University

2023 | Outstanding Advisor for Undergraduate Thesis, Hunan University

2022 | INQUIRE Europe Research Grant Award

2021 | Best Paper Award, Graduate Student Forum on Economics & Finance, Antai College, SJTU

2021 | College of Business PhD Student Conference Grant, City University of Hong Kong

2018-2022 | Ph.D. Studentship, City University of Hong Kong

2016 | Second Prize, National Contest of Industrial Engineering Applications, Tsinghua University

2015,2016,2017 | Academic Excellence Award, Shanghai Jiao Tong University

Teaching

USTC | * Students' evaluation in the parentheses.
- Empirical Asset Pricing. MF. 2026 Spring (None)
- Empirical Asset Pricing. MS. 2026 Spring (None)
- Financial Institutions and Financial Market. BS. 2026 Spring (None)
- Lectures on Financial Engineering and Advanced Topics. 2025 Spring (None)

Hunan University
- Simulation and Experiments in Financial Engineering. 2023 Summer (None)
- Fixed-Income Securities. 2023 Autumn (98.00/100)
- Behavioral Finance. 2023 Autumn (97.73/100)

Universities and Financial Institutions
- Guest Speaker: Asset Pricing and Quantitative Investment

Service

Ad Hoc Referee	Management Science, Journal of Banking & Finance, Journal of Empirical Finance, Journal of Finance and Data Science, Journal of Financial Econometrics, Journal of Financial Markets, Annals of Operations Research, Asia-Pacific Journal of Accounting and Economics, Asia-Pacific Journal of Operations Research, Econometrics and Statistics, Economic Modelling, European Financial Management, Financial Innovation, Financial Research Letters, International Journal of Finance & Economics, International Journal of Theoretical and Applied Finance, International Review of Finance, Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Finance, Journal of International Financial Markets, Institutions & Money, Quantitative Finance, Review of Managerial Science.
Conference Organizer	2025 and 2026 USTC Frontiers in Finance Conference 2023 Workshop on Empirical Asset Pricing, College of Finance and Statistics, Hunan University
Program Committee	2022, 2024 FMA Annual Meeting
Session Chair	2022 INFORMS Annual Meeting Indianapolis

Miscellaneous

Programming	Python, R, MATLAB, C++, SAS, Linux, SQL, LaTeX, Microsoft Office
Database	CRSP, Compustat, IBES, TRACE, FISD, Wind, CSMAR
Hobby	Arsenal FC, Sports (fitness, jogging, soccer, basketball, go), Reading (geograghy, philosophy)

Presentation

2026

- AsianFA Annual Conference, Seoul National University (2026/7, Seoul)
- SoFiE Annual Conference, University of Macau (2026/6, Macau)
- Hong Kong Conference on Fintech and AI in Finance (2026/6, HK)
- Invited Seminar, PBC School of Finance, Tsinghua University (2026/4, Beijing)

2025 EUROFIDAI-ESSEC Paris December Finance Meeting (2025/12, Paris);Fudan International Symposium on AI in Finance, Fudan University (2025/11, SH);Conference on Big Data, AI, and FinTech, Sun Yat-sen University (2025/10, Guangzhou);FinTech and Financial Markets Workshop, University of Macau (2025/10, Macau);Invited Seminar, Antai College, Shanghai Jiao Tong University (2025/10, SH);Invited Practitioner Talk, AITOPIA (2024/7, Online);USTC Frontiers in Finance Conference, USTC (2025/7, Hefei);Invited Seminar, School of Management, USTC (2025/6, Hefei);Hong Kong Conference for Fintech, AI, and Big Data in Business (2025/5, HK);Invited Seminar, School of Management, USTC (2025/5, Hefei);Invited Seminar, Institute for Financial Studies, SWUFE (2025/4, Chengdu);Annual Meeting of Chinese Statistical Association of Young Scholars (2025/4, Jinan);Invited Seminar, School of Management, Xiamen University (2025/3, Xiamen);Invited Seminar, School of Economics, Sichuan University (2025/3, Chengdu)

2024 Young Scholar Asset Pricing Workshop, SOE, Xiamen University (2024/10, Xiamen);Invited Seminar, School of Finance, SWUFE (2024/5, Chengdu);Invited Seminar, School of Management, USTC (2024/3, Hefei)

2023 Invited Seminar, School of Management, Xiamen University (2023/11, Xiamen); AI and Big Data in Accounting and Finance Conference, XJTLU (2023/6, Suzhou); Financial Econometrics Conference, Lancaster University (2023/3, Lancaster)

2022 Australasian Finance & Banking Conference, UNSW (2022/12, Online); New Zealand Finance Meeting, AUT (2022/12, Online); 5th Conference on Big Data, AI, and FinTech, SYSU (2022/11, Online); China Finance Annual Meeting, SJTU (2022/10, Online) ; China International Risk Forum, DUFE (2022/7, Online); Asian Meeting of the Econometric Society in China, CUHK(SZ) (2022/6, Online); 6th PKU-NUS Annual International Conference on Quantitative Finance and Economics, NUS (2022/5, Online)

2021 China Finance Annual Meeting, Xiamen University (2021/10, Online); INFORMS Annual Meeting (2021/10, Online); Financial Management Association Annual Meeting (2021/10, Online); Seminar, City University of Hong Kong (2021/9, Hong Kong); SoFiE Financial Econometrics Summer School, NYU SH (2021/8, Online); China International Risk Forum, SWUFE (2021/7, Chengdu); 37th International Conference of the French Finance Association, Audencia Business School (2021/5, Online); 4th China Accounting and Finance Conference, Sichuan University (2021/4, Online); Financial Markets and Corporate Governance Conference, La Trobe University (2021/4, Online); Camphor Economic Society Seminar Beijing (2021/2, Online); Camphor Economic Society Seminar Fujian (2021/1, Online);

Discussion

2025

- "Deciphering the Impact of BigTech Consumer Credit" at Conference on Big Data, AI, and FinTech, Sun Yat-sen University, Guangzhou, China.
- "Nonverbal Information in Expectation Management – A Multimodal Perspective (in Chinese)" at CFRC, Tsinghua University PBCSF, Beijing, China.
- "Oil-Driven Greenium" at International Conference on Green Finance and ESG, at Southwestern University of Finance and Economics, Chengdu, China.

2024

- "Carbon Risk and the Cost of Debt" at Greater China Area Finance Conference, Xiamen University
- "Investor Sentiment and Cryptocurrency Returns" at Greater China Area Finance Conference, Xiamen University

2023

- "Do Insurers Listen to Earnings Conference Calls? Evidence from the Corporate Bond Market" at XJTLU

2022

- "Abnormal Downside Tail Risk as a Predictor of the Risky Bond Returns" at AFBC
- "Financial Consequences of the Belt and Road Initiative" at NZFM
- "Air Pollution and Bank Loan Pricing" at SYSU conference on Big Data, AI, and FinTech
- "Corporate Bond Pricing Using Interpretable and Arbitrage-Free Model" at CIRF

2021

- "Manager Uncertainty and the Cross-Section of Stock Returns" at FMA
- "Does Reputation Matter? Evidence on Spatial Competition in China's Bond Market" at FMCG

2020

- "How should we measure the performance of corporate bond mutual funds? Evaluating model quality and impact on inferences" at FMA

Last Update: April 16, 2026